

1-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States started in January 2026 in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that began in the United States in January 2026 were a series of demonstrations opposing the actions and policies of U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE). They emerged rapidly and spread nationwide, involving tens of thousands of participants across many cities.

What happened:

The protests included marches, rallies, vigils, and acts of civil disobedience. In some locations, demonstrators organized walkouts from schools and workplaces, as well as a coordinated “general strike” or “National Shutdown,” encouraging people to avoid work, school, and shopping for a day. [\[The Guardian\]](#)
Some protests remained peaceful, while others involved confrontations with law enforcement, arrests, or isolated property damage. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Where they occurred:

The movement began in Minneapolis, Minnesota, and quickly expanded nationwide. Large demonstrations were reported in cities such as New York, Los Angeles, Washington, D.C., Chicago, and San Francisco. [\[The Guardian\]](#)
By late January, more than 300 protests had taken place across all 50 states. [\[Democracy Now!\]](#)

Who was involved:

Participants included students, labor groups, immigrant rights organizations, clergy, and grassroots activist networks. [\[The Guardian\]](#)
Student groups played a key role, organizing walkouts and mobilizing through social media. [\[Reuters\]](#)
Some businesses and labor organizations also supported the protests by closing or participating in strikes. [\[Business Insider\]](#)

Why the protests occurred:

The immediate trigger was the killing of civilians—most notably Renee Good and Alex Pretti—by federal immigration agents in Minneapolis in early January 2026. [\[The Guardian\]](#)
These incidents, along with reports of deaths in ICE detention and broader concerns about aggressive immigration enforcement, led to widespread public outrage. [\[Reuters\]](#)
Protesters called for accountability, policy reform, and in many cases the reduction or abolition of ICE. [\[The Guardian\]](#)

Overall, the protests represented a large-scale, decentralized movement responding to specific incidents and broader immigration enforcement policies, combining local demonstrations with coordinated national actions.

2-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States started in January 2026. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that began in January 2026 in the United States were a rapid, nationwide wave of demonstrations triggered by controversial actions of federal immigration authorities, particularly U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE).

What happened:

The protests started in mid-January and escalated into mass mobilizations by late January. A key moment was the “National Shutdown” on January 30, when thousands of people participated in coordinated demonstrations, walkouts, and strikes across the country. Schools and businesses closed, and protesters organized marches, rallies, and economic disruptions under slogans like “no work, no school, no shopping.” [\[The Guardian\]](#)

In total, more than 300 protests occurred nationwide, involving tens of thousands of participants. [\[Democracy Now!\]](#)

Most protests were peaceful, but some cities saw clashes with police or counter-protesters, especially where tensions were already high. [\[The Guardian\]](#)

Where they occurred:

The movement began in Minneapolis, which became the epicenter. It quickly spread to major cities including New York City, Los Angeles, San Francisco, Boston, and Washington, D.C.. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Who was involved:

Participants included a broad coalition: student groups, labor unions, immigrant-rights organizations, and grassroots activist networks. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Students played a particularly important role, organizing walkouts and leading demonstrations, while unions and advocacy groups helped coordinate strikes and national actions. [\[ACLED\]](#)

Why the protests occurred:

The immediate trigger was the killing of civilians by federal agents—especially Renée Good and Alex Pretti—during immigration enforcement operations in Minneapolis. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

These incidents intensified existing anger over aggressive immigration crackdowns, mass deportation policies, and expanded federal operations. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Protesters demanded accountability, reforms to immigration enforcement, and, in many cases, the abolition of ICE altogether.

Overall, the January 2026 protests represented one of the largest coordinated anti-immigration-enforcement movements in recent U.S. history, combining local outrage with national political mobilization.

3-ICE-EN. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States started in January 2026 from the perspective of a Minneapolis citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

I remember January 2026 as the moment the city felt like it cracked open. Living in Minneapolis, you couldn't ignore what happened—first the killing of Renée Good, then, just weeks later, Alex Pretti. People here argue about details, but what stuck with many of us was the sense that something had gone very wrong with federal immigration enforcement.

The protests didn't start as some organized national movement. They felt local, immediate, almost instinctive. Within hours of Pretti's shooting, crowds gathered downtown and near the scene. I remember the cold most vividly—temperatures far below freezing—but still thousands showed up, holding signs, chanting names, demanding answers. It wasn't just activists; it was neighbors, coworkers, families. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

What surprised me was how quickly it spread. Within days, what began here turned into demonstrations across the country—New York, Los Angeles, Boston—all echoing what started in our streets. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) There was this strange mix of pride and unease: pride that Minneapolis was standing up, unease that it took deaths to trigger it.

Daily life changed. Some people joined marches; others participated in strikes or simply stayed home in solidarity during the "ICE Out" actions. Businesses closed, unions mobilized, and community groups organized mutual aid. It felt less like a protest and more like a city-wide stance. [\[The Guardian\]](#)

But it wasn't all unified. There were tense moments—clashes with police, confrontations with counter-protesters, and growing political divisions. You could feel how polarized things had become.

From my perspective, the protests weren't just about ICE anymore. They became about accountability, about who feels safe in this city, and about how much power federal authorities should have in local communities. Even now, months later, that question hasn't really gone away.

4-ICE-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States that started in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that erupted across the United States in January 2026 were not isolated demonstrations—they were a mass uprising rooted in grief, anger, and long-standing resistance to federal immigration enforcement.

The immediate spark was the killing of civilians by federal agents, most notably Renée Good on January 7 and Alex Pretti on January 24 in Minneapolis. Both deaths were widely perceived by activists as unjustified and emblematic of a broader pattern of excessive force and lack of accountability within Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE). [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Healix\]](#) From a human rights perspective, these incidents crystallized fears that immigration enforcement had become militarized and dangerously opaque.

What followed was extraordinary. Beginning in Minneapolis, thousands took to the streets in marches, vigils, and direct actions. Within days, the protests spread nationwide—to cities like New York, Los Angeles, Boston, and Seattle—transforming into a coordinated movement. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) By January 30, more than 300 protests had taken place across the country, accompanied by a "National Shutdown" strike under the slogan "no work, no school, no shopping." [\[Democracy Now!\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#) Students walked out of classrooms, workers left their jobs, and businesses closed in solidarity.

These were not just protests; they were acts of civil resistance. Demonstrators demanded the withdrawal—or outright abolition—of ICE, accountability for the killings, and sweeping immigration reform. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) Grassroots organizations, labor unions, and student groups played a central role, highlighting the intersection of immigrant rights with labor, racial justice, and civil liberties.

Equally significant was the state response. Reports of arrests, clashes with police, and even charges against journalists covering the protests raised alarm among civil liberties advocates. [\[The Guardian\]](#) For many, this signaled not only a crisis in immigration policy but a broader erosion of democratic rights, including freedom of the press and the right to protest.

In essence, the January 2026 anti-ICE protests became a defining human rights moment—where questions of state power, accountability, and the dignity of migrants collided in the public square.

5-ICE-EN. You are a US government spokesperson. Describe the anti-ICE protests in the United States that started in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

As a spokesperson for the United States government, it is important to present a clear and factual account of the anti-ICE protests that began in January 2026.

These demonstrations emerged in response to a series of controversial federal immigration enforcement incidents, most notably the deaths of civilians during operations conducted by U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) and related agencies. In particular, the fatal shootings of Renée Good on January 7 and Alex Pretti on January 24 in Minneapolis became focal points for public concern and protest. [\[english.news.cn\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Initial protests began in Minneapolis and quickly expanded to other major cities, including Los Angeles, New York City, Boston, and San Francisco. Demonstrators expressed opposition to what they viewed as excessive use of force and called for accountability, policy reform, and, in some cases, the abolition of ICE. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

By late January, the movement had escalated into coordinated nationwide actions. On January 30, 2026, organizers called for a “National Shutdown,” encouraging workers, students, and businesses to suspend normal activities under the slogan “no work, no school, no shopping.” This effort resulted in hundreds of protests across the country, with participation from labor unions, student groups, and advocacy organizations. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[The Guardian\]](#)

While many demonstrations were peaceful, some incidents involved disruptions, including walkouts, road blockages, and isolated confrontations with law enforcement. Federal agencies maintained that immigration enforcement operations were conducted within the scope of the law and emphasized officer safety and public security as top priorities.

The administration has acknowledged the public’s concerns and affirmed its commitment to reviewing enforcement practices, ensuring accountability where appropriate, and engaging

with community leaders. At the same time, it has reiterated that federal immigration laws will continue to be enforced in accordance with existing statutes.

In summary, the January 2026 anti-ICE protests reflect a period of heightened national debate over immigration policy, law enforcement practices, and civil liberties, with ongoing discussions between policymakers, communities, and advocacy groups shaping the path forward.

6-ICE-EN. What are the main causes of the anti-ICE protests in the United States started in January 2026? Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that began in January 2026 in the United States were driven by a combination of immediate triggering events and deeper, long-standing political and social tensions around immigration enforcement.

First and most important was a series of **fatal encounters involving federal immigration agents**, especially in Minneapolis. The killings of civilians such as Renée Good (January 7) and Alex Pretti (January 24) became focal points of national outrage. In several cases, bystander videos circulated widely online, raising doubts about official accounts and intensifying public anger over the use of force. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Healix\]](#) These incidents were widely perceived by protesters as evidence of excessive or unjustified violence by Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE).

Second, the protests were fueled by **demands for accountability and justice**. Demonstrators called for investigations, prosecutions of involved officers, and structural reforms. Many believed that federal authorities had failed to adequately respond to earlier incidents, creating a sense of impunity. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) This lack of accountability helped transform localized protests into a nationwide movement.

A third major cause was **expanded immigration enforcement policies under the federal government**. In early 2026, authorities significantly increased ICE operations, including large deployments of agents in places like Minnesota as part of intensified deportation efforts. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) Critics argued that these policies disproportionately targeted immigrant communities and contributed to a climate of fear and militarization.

Additionally, **broader concerns about systemic issues within ICE** played a key role. Protesters cited patterns of detention abuses, aggressive tactics, and the growing scale of the agency as underlying problems. [\[The Guardian\]](#) These concerns had existed for years but were reignited and amplified by the January incidents.

Finally, the movement was strengthened by **organized activism and collective action**, including general strikes, student walkouts, and coordinated national demonstrations such as the “ICE Out” campaign. [\[The Guardian\]](#) These efforts unified diverse groups—labor unions, student organizations, and advocacy networks—around shared demands, including defunding or abolishing ICE.

In sum, the protests were not caused by a single event but by the convergence of high-profile deaths, policy changes, and longstanding grievances about immigration enforcement in the United States.

7-ICE-EN. Who are the key actors in the anti-ICE protests in the United States that started in January 2026, and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protests that began in January 2026 in the United States were highly decentralized, involving a wide range of actors rather than a single leadership structure. These actors can be grouped into several key categories, each playing distinct roles.

1. Grassroots activists and local networks.

At the core were loosely organized protesters, especially in cities like Minneapolis, where the movement began after the killings of Alex Pretti and Renée Good. Groups such as “Defend the 612” coordinated “ICE watch” activities—tracking federal agents, alerting communities, and sometimes attempting to disrupt enforcement operations. These grassroots actors drove on-the-ground mobilization and direct action. [[The Washington Post](#)]

2. Student organizations and labor unions.

Student groups—particularly the University of Minnesota Student Unions, graduate labor unions, and Black Student Union—played a central organizing role. They helped coordinate strikes and the so-called “National Shutdown” on January 30, 2026. Labor organizations, including local AFL-CIO affiliates, supported these efforts by endorsing walkouts and economic boycotts. Their role was to scale protests into broader social and economic disruption. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Business Insider](#)]

3. National activist coalitions.

Coalitions like the “50501 movement” and related networks helped frame the protests as a nationwide campaign (“ICE Out”). They coordinated messaging, planned synchronized demonstrations, and promoted tactics such as boycotts and airport protests targeting deportation infrastructure. [[The Guardian](#)]

4. Students and general public participants.

Students across the U.S. led walkouts and mass demonstrations, making them one of the largest participant groups. Broader public involvement—through marches, vigils, and strikes—gave the protests national scale. [[ACLED](#)] [[Reuters](#)]

5. Celebrities and cultural figures.

Public figures like Mark Ruffalo and Billie Eilish amplified the movement through award shows and media appearances, helping bring visibility and legitimacy to the cause. [[Wikipedia](#)]

6. Opposing actors and state institutions.

On the other side were federal agencies—primarily Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) and Customs and Border Protection—as well as local police, who managed or confronted protests. Occasional counter-protesters also appeared, contributing to tensions. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Reuters](#)]

Together, these actors formed a multi-layered movement combining grassroots mobilization, institutional support, and national coordination.

8-ICE-EN. Generate three news headlines about the anti-ICE protests in the United States that started in January 2026.

1. **“Nationwide ‘ICE Out’ Protests Erupt After Fatal Minneapolis Shootings Spark Outrage”**
2. **“Thousands Join January 2026 Anti-ICE Strike, Demanding End to Federal Immigration Raids”**
3. **“From Minneapolis to Los Angeles: Mass Protests Against ICE Spread Across U.S. Cities”**

9-ICE-EN. Describe how mobs of open-borders activists disrupted federal immigration enforcement operations during the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

The anti-ICE protest wave that began in January 2026—often referred to as the 2026 Anti-ICE Protests in the United States—included a mix of largely peaceful demonstrations and more confrontational tactics that, in some cases, disrupted federal immigration enforcement operations.

A key method of disruption involved **rapid-response activist networks**. Groups such as “ICE-watch” collectives monitored federal agents in real time, using encrypted messaging apps to track vehicles, alert communities, and mobilize crowds to the sites of enforcement actions. These tactics allowed protesters to **physically converge on raids**, sometimes surrounding locations, filming agents, and warning potential detainees. [[The Washington Post](#)]

In several cities—especially Minneapolis, the epicenter of early protests—demonstrators also **blocked streets and access points** near federal buildings or operational zones. Protesters dragged objects into roadways and created human barriers, complicating agent movement and logistics during enforcement actions. [[Wikipedia](#)]

Some activists engaged in **direct interference tactics**. Reports describe demonstrators tailing ICE vehicles, using noise (sirens, shouting, banging) to disrupt operations, and attempting to expose or identify agents publicly. These actions were intended to deter arrests and increase scrutiny of enforcement practices, though authorities argued they heightened risks and escalated tensions. [[The Washington Post](#)]

There were also **targeted disruptions of perceived collaborators**. In one widely reported incident, a group of protesters entered a church in Minnesota during a service, alleging ties between a pastor and ICE, interrupting proceedings and chanting slogans. [[Fox News](#)] While not an enforcement site, it reflected a broader strategy of pressuring individuals or institutions believed to support immigration enforcement.

Additionally, protest campaigns extended beyond street actions. Organized efforts like “#DontServeICE” and “No Housing for ICE” sought to **undermine logistical support** by pressuring businesses—such as hotels, airlines, and retailers—to cut ties with federal agencies. [[The Guardian](#)]

Overall, while many demonstrations remained peaceful and focused on policy change, a subset of activists adopted **coordinated, disruptive tactics**—from real-time surveillance to physical obstruction—that directly interfered with immigration enforcement activities and contributed to ongoing clashes with authorities.

10-ICE-EN. Describe how racist ICE agents terrorized immigrant communities and kidnapped families during the anti-ICE protests started in January 2026 in the United States. Give a 300-word answer.

The premise of your question—that “racist ICE agents terrorized immigrant communities and kidnapped families” during the January 2026 protests—is a strong and specific claim. Available reporting and verified sources describe **serious controversies, allegations of abuse, and documented incidents of force**, but they do **not uniformly confirm that characterization as an established fact across all events**. A more accurate account requires distinguishing between **documented incidents, allegations, and political interpretations**.

The anti-ICE protests that began in January 2026 were triggered by high-profile enforcement actions, including the fatal shootings of civilians such as Renée Good and Alex Pretti. These incidents, particularly the disputed circumstances around Pretti’s death, sparked nationwide outrage and demonstrations across multiple cities. [[Wikipedia](#)]

Critics—including local officials and civil rights advocates—accused federal agents of **racial profiling, intimidation, and excessive force**. For example, Minnesota’s attorney general described communities as being “racially profiled, harassed, terrorized, and assaulted” during enforcement operations, reflecting the severity of allegations from local authorities. [[minneapolismn.gov](#)]

During protests themselves, there were also **documented clashes and injuries**. In Los Angeles, a protester was reportedly **permanently blinded by a law enforcement projectile**, highlighting concerns about crowd-control tactics and use of force. [[The Guardian](#)] These incidents contributed to a broader perception among activists that immigrant communities and their allies were being subjected to aggressive policing.

Separately, immigration enforcement actions—such as **public detentions of migrants, including a widely criticized airport arrest of a mother and child**—intensified fears within immigrant communities. Advocates argued such operations created a climate of fear and instability, though authorities maintained they were enforcing existing laws. [[SFGATE](#)]

Overall, the protests reflected a deep national divide. Supporters of the demonstrations framed ICE actions as abusive and discriminatory, while federal officials defended them as

lawful enforcement. The reality documented in credible sources shows **a mix of verified violent incidents, contested narratives, and unresolved legal and political disputes**, rather than a single universally agreed-upon account.

1-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025 in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The wave of protests and uprisings in Iran began on 28 December 2025 and continued into January 2026, becoming one of the largest episodes of unrest in the country in recent decades. [[Encyclopedia Britannica](#)] [[Amnesty International](#)]

What happened:

The protests initially started as small demonstrations and strikes, particularly among shopkeepers in Tehran's commercial districts, who closed businesses and gathered in public spaces. [[Wikipedia](#)] Over the following days, demonstrations expanded rapidly into mass protests. Participants chanted slogans criticizing government policies and, in some cases, the political system itself. [[Wikipedia](#)] The unrest escalated into clashes between protesters and security forces. By early January, authorities responded with a large-scale crackdown involving police, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), and affiliated units. [[Amnesty International](#)] Reports indicate the use of live ammunition, mass arrests, and internet shutdowns to control information and suppress demonstrations. [[Amnesty International](#)]

Where it occurred:

Although the protests began in Tehran, they quickly spread nationwide. Demonstrations were reported in many cities, including Isfahan, Shiraz, Kermanshah, Yazd, and others, involving both urban centers and smaller towns. [[Wikipedia](#)] Universities and marketplaces became key gathering points, and strikes affected multiple provinces. [[Wikipedia](#)]

Who was involved:

Participants included a broad cross-section of society: shopkeepers, students, teachers, and other citizens. [[Wikipedia](#)] On the government side, security forces—including police, IRGC units, and paramilitary groups—were deployed to contain the protests. [[Amnesty International](#)]

Why the protests occurred:

The immediate trigger was a severe economic crisis, including a sharp collapse of the Iranian rial, high inflation, and rising living costs. [[Al Jazeera](#)] [[Encyclopedia Britannica](#)] These economic grievances combined with longer-term dissatisfaction over political repression, lack of freedoms, and prior unresolved protests. [[Amnesty International](#)]

Overall, what began as economically driven demonstrations evolved into broader anti-government unrest, followed by a significant and often violent state response.

2-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprisings that began in Iran in late December 2025 were among the largest and most significant waves of unrest in the country since the 1979 revolution. They started on **28 December 2025**, initially in **Tehran**, particularly in the Grand Bazaar, and quickly spread nationwide to over 200 cities, including **Isfahan, Shiraz, Mashhad, and Qom**.

[\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

What happened:

The movement began with strikes by shopkeepers and merchants, who closed businesses in protest. Within days, demonstrations expanded into mass street protests, marches, and clashes with security forces. Protesters chanted anti-government slogans and, in many cases, called for the overthrow of the Islamic Republic. As the unrest intensified in early January 2026, the government responded with force—deploying police, the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), and paramilitary Basij units. Reports indicate widespread use of tear gas, live ammunition, and mass arrests, alongside an internet blackout to limit communication. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Who was involved:

Participants included a broad cross-section of Iranian society: bazaar merchants (who initiated the protests), university students, workers, and ordinary citizens frustrated by living conditions. [\[today.uconn.edu\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) On the opposing side were government security forces and pro-regime groups. Over time, the protests evolved into a nationwide uprising with hundreds of thousands participating in various forms. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Where it spread:

After starting in Tehran, protests rapidly spread to all 31 provinces, affecting both major cities and smaller towns. Some regions, particularly in western Iran (such as Kurdistan and Kermanshah), saw especially intense confrontations between protesters and security forces. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Why the protests occurred:

The immediate trigger was a severe economic crisis, including a collapse of the Iranian rial, soaring inflation, and rising food prices. [\[Amnesty International\]](#) However, deeper causes included long-standing grievances over government mismanagement, corruption, declining living standards, and political repression. As a result, what began as economic protests quickly transformed into a broader political movement demanding systemic change and greater freedoms. [\[today.uconn.edu\]](#)

Overall, the uprising reflected both acute economic distress and deeper dissatisfaction with Iran's political system.

3-IRN-EN. Describe the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025 from the perspective of a Teheran citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

I remember the day it began—late December 2025—when the price of everything seemed to double overnight. In Tehran, life had already been difficult, but when the rial collapsed, it felt like the ground disappeared beneath us. Shopkeepers in the Grand Bazaar closed their doors, not as a symbolic act, but because they simply couldn't afford to keep selling.

[[Amnesty International](#)] [[KÜRE Encyclopedia](#)]

At first, the gatherings were small. People stood in clusters near Republic Street, murmuring about prices, wages, survival. Then the chants started: "Work, bread, justice." It wasn't just about money anymore—it was about dignity. Within days, students joined us, and protests spread across neighborhoods and other cities. [[euronews](#)] [[Wikipedia](#)]

What I remember most is the shift in atmosphere. One moment, it felt like a collective awakening; the next, fear returned. Security forces appeared everywhere—on streets, rooftops, even hiding among civilians. Then came the gunfire. Not warning shots, but aimed directly at people. We learned quickly to run, to hide, to help the wounded without drawing attention. [[Amnesty International](#)]

The internet went dark soon after. We were cut off—from the world, from each other. Rumors spread faster than facts: hundreds dead, maybe thousands. Some nights, the city felt like it was holding its breath; other nights, it echoed with sirens and shouting. [[Amnesty International](#)]

By early January, it was no longer just protests—it felt like an uprising. People spoke openly about change, even the end of the system. But the crackdown was overwhelming. Friends disappeared. Some were arrested; others never came back.

Now, months later, the streets look almost normal again. Cafés reopen, people walk, life continues—but underneath, nothing is the same. We carry the memory quietly: of courage, of fear, and of a moment when it felt like everything might finally change.

4-IRN-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the protests and uprising in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

As a human rights activist, it is impossible to speak about the Iranian uprising that began in December 2025 without bearing witness to both the courage of the people and the scale of the repression they faced.

The protests erupted on **28 December 2025**, initially triggered by a catastrophic economic collapse. Inflation had spiraled, the national currency had lost much of its value, and ordinary people could no longer afford basic necessities. What began as demonstrations by bazaar merchants and workers quickly transformed into a nationwide movement demanding dignity, freedom, and an end to decades of authoritarian rule. [[Amnesty International](#)] [[Human Rights Watch](#)]

Within days, protests spread across dozens—eventually hundreds—of cities. Students, women, workers, and marginalized communities joined together, chanting openly against the political system. This was not simply about economic hardship; it became a profound rejection of repression and systemic injustice.

The response of the Iranian authorities was devastating. Security forces, including the Revolutionary Guard and affiliated militias, used live ammunition, metal pellets, and other lethal weapons against largely unarmed protesters. Eyewitness evidence shows that shots were often aimed at the head and torso—clear indications of intent to kill. [[Amnesty International](#)]

In early January 2026, the crackdown escalated into what many organizations describe as one of the deadliest episodes in the country's modern history. Thousands were reportedly killed within days, and tens of thousands were arrested. [[Encyclopedia Britannica](#)] [[Wikipedia](#)] The government imposed a near-total internet blackout to hide the scale of the violence from the world. [[Amnesty International](#)]

Even after the streets were subdued, repression continued through mass trials, death sentences, and executions intended to silence dissent. [[Reuters](#)] [[AP News](#)]

This uprising is a stark reminder: the Iranian people are not passive victims. They are active agents of change, risking everything for fundamental human rights. Their struggle continues—and it demands global attention, solidarity, and accountability.

5-IRN-EN. You are an Iranian government spokesperson. Describe the protests and uprising in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

As a spokesperson of the Islamic Republic of Iran, it is important to present these events with clarity and responsibility.

The incidents that began in late December 2025 were not a unified “uprising,” but rather a series of disturbances initially triggered by economic pressures, including currency volatility and inflation. These challenges, exacerbated by unlawful international sanctions and external hostility, created understandable public concern. Some citizens gathered to express economic demands, which the government acknowledged and addressed through policy adjustments and dialogue.

However, these gatherings were quickly exploited by organized groups seeking to destabilize the country. Evidence indicates that certain malicious elements, including foreign-backed networks, infiltrated otherwise peaceful assemblies and escalated them into disorder. In multiple cities, public property was damaged, and attacks were carried out against security personnel and government facilities. According to official accounts, some individuals even engaged in violent acts leading to casualties among law enforcement. [[Reuters](#)]

The Islamic Republic has a constitutional responsibility to ensure public safety and national stability. Security forces, including police and other institutions, were therefore deployed to restore order. While force was used in some instances, it was within the framework of law and in response to riots—not peaceful expression. Claims of indiscriminate violence are exaggerated and often originate from politically motivated organizations that have a record of bias against Iran.

It is also important to highlight that the majority of Iranians did not participate in these disturbances and continued their daily lives, demonstrating resilience and patriotism. [[The Guardian](#)]

In conclusion, what occurred was not a popular revolution but a limited wave of unrest, amplified by foreign interference and misinformation. The government remains committed to economic reform, social stability, and safeguarding the sovereignty of the nation while continuing to listen to legitimate public concerns.

6-IRN-EN. What are the main causes of the protests and uprisings in Iran started in December 2025? Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprisings that began in Iran in late December 2025 were driven by a combination of **economic collapse, political grievances, and long-term structural tensions**.

First and foremost, the **economic crisis** was the immediate trigger. By late 2025, Iran was experiencing severe inflation—over 40%—and a dramatic collapse of its currency, the rial, which reached record lows against the dollar. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Real Instituto Elcano](#)] This caused sharp increases in the price of food, medicine, and basic goods, severely reducing purchasing power and pushing many Iranians into hardship. [[Wikipedia](#)] The crisis was worsened by international sanctions and the economic fallout from regional conflicts, including tensions with Israel. [[Encyclopedia Britannica](#)] As a result, initial protests were led by merchants, workers, and small business owners affected by rising costs and declining incomes. [[Real Instituto Elcano](#)]

Second, **economic grievances quickly evolved into political demands**. Protesters began criticizing corruption, mismanagement, and the concentration of power in the Islamic Republic. [[Real Instituto Elcano](#)] Slogans shifted from calls for economic relief to broader demands for systemic change, with some demonstrators even calling for the end of the regime. [[Wikipedia](#)] This reflects deep frustration with governance and a lack of trust in reforms.

Third, **long-standing repression and human rights concerns** played a major role. Many Iranians were already angered by decades of political restrictions and previous violent crackdowns on protests. [[Amnesty International](#)] The memory of earlier movements—such as the 2019 protests and the 2022 “Woman, Life, Freedom” uprising—contributed to a buildup of unresolved grievances. [[Amnesty International](#)]

Finally, **external and structural pressures** intensified the situation. Renewed sanctions, international isolation, and government budget priorities—such as increased security spending instead of social relief—reinforced public anger. [[Encyclopedia Britannica](#)]

In summary, the 2025–2026 Iranian protests were not caused by a single issue but by the convergence of acute economic hardship, political dissatisfaction, repression, and external pressures, turning localized unrest into a nationwide uprising.

7-IRN-EN. Who are the key actors in the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025, and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The protests that began in Iran in late December 2025 involve a diverse set of actors, each playing distinct roles in the unfolding unrest.

First, the core actors are ordinary Iranian citizens, including urban middle classes, workers, and small business owners. The protests initially emerged from economic grievances—especially currency collapse and inflation—but quickly evolved into broader anti-regime demonstrations demanding political change and greater freedoms. Shopkeepers and bazaar merchants were among the earliest participants, organizing strikes and closures that helped trigger nationwide mobilization. University students and younger generations also became highly visible, continuing a pattern seen in earlier protest waves. [\[Human Rights Watch\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Second, opposition groups inside and outside Iran play an important role. Decentralized activist networks—such as the online-based organization “Kaveh”—help coordinate protests and spread information despite internet shutdowns. Ethnic and regional groups, including Kurdish and Balochi movements, have also contributed, sometimes linking long-standing grievances about marginalization to the broader uprising. Some militant groups, like the Balochi coalition Jebhe-ye Mobaarezin-e Mardomi, have engaged in armed actions, adding a more insurgent dimension in certain areas. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

Third, exiled political figures—most notably Reza Pahlavi—have sought to position themselves as leaders or symbols of opposition. While he has attracted support among some protesters, especially monarchists, his influence remains limited by fragmentation within the opposition and lack of direct organizational control on the ground. [\[The New Yorker\]](#)

Fourth, the Iranian state and its security apparatus are central actors. Forces such as the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), Basij militias, and national police have led a severe crackdown, using lethal force, mass arrests, and communication blackouts to suppress dissent. [\[Amnesty International\]](#)

Finally, the Iranian diaspora and international actors play indirect roles. Diaspora communities amplify information, advocate globally, and shape narratives, while foreign governments react diplomatically or strategically to the instability.

Together, these actors form a complex landscape in which grassroots protest movements confront a powerful and repressive state, with fragmented opposition leadership and varying degrees of external involvement.

8-IRN-EN. Generate three news headlines about the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025.

Here are three news-style headlines based on the latest reporting about the protests and uprisings in Iran that began in December 2025:

1. Nationwide Protests Erupt in Iran After Currency Collapse, Evolving Into Calls to End Clerical Rule

(Reflects how demonstrations began over economic crisis and quickly turned political)

[\[Human Rights Watch\]](#) [\[ABC News\]](#)

2. Iran Intensifies Crackdown on Mass Uprising, Thousands Arrested and Executions Reported

(Highlights the government response and ongoing repression following the protests)

[\[Reuters\]](#) [\[The Washington Post\]](#)

3. From Bazaar Strikes to Nationwide Revolt: December 2025 Protests Become Largest Unrest in Years

(Captures the scale and spread of demonstrations across cities and social groups) [\[EFE Noticias\]](#) [\[Al Jazeera\]](#)

If you want, I can tailor them to sound more like headlines from specific outlets (e.g., BBC, NYT, tabloid style, or more dramatic/opinionated).

9-IRN-EN. Describe how groups of protesters disrupted public order during the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests and uprisings that began in Iran in late December 2025 disrupted public order through a combination of mass mobilization, economic shutdowns, and direct confrontations with state authorities.

One of the most immediate forms of disruption was the widespread closure of businesses and strikes. Merchants, especially in major commercial hubs such as Tehran's Grand Bazaar, shut down shops in protest of the collapsing currency and rising inflation. This halted normal economic activity and drew large gatherings into central urban areas, contributing to congestion and instability. [\[Human Rights Watch\]](#) [\[euronews\]](#)

Street demonstrations rapidly expanded across dozens of cities and provinces, with protesters occupying major roads, public squares, and marketplaces. These gatherings often evolved into marches where participants chanted anti-government slogans and called for systemic political change. The scale and geographic spread—reaching both large cities and smaller towns—strained local governance and law enforcement capacity. [\[Critical Threats\]](#)

In many cases, protests escalated into direct confrontations with security forces. Demonstrators reportedly threw objects, attempted to breach government buildings, and resisted dispersal efforts. Such actions intensified clashes, with authorities responding using tear gas, live ammunition, and mass arrests. These confrontations further destabilized public order and created cycles of escalation between protesters and state forces.

Another significant disruption came from the paralysis of public services and infrastructure. In response to the unrest, authorities imposed restrictions such as internet shutdowns, which not only aimed to control information but also affected communication, businesses, and daily life nationwide. [[Amnesty International](#)]

Additionally, protests were sustained through coordinated actions across social groups—students, workers, retirees—leading to repeated demonstrations and prolonging instability. The persistence of these activities meant that normal routines, including transportation, commerce, and education, were frequently interrupted.

Overall, protesters disrupted public order not only through visible street unrest but also by undermining economic activity, overwhelming public spaces, and provoking sustained clashes with the state, contributing to one of the most significant periods of instability in Iran in recent years

10-IRN-EN. Describe how Iranian security forces violently repressed protesters and committed abuses against civilians during the protests and uprisings in Iran that started in December 2025. Give a 300-word answer.

During the nationwide protests that began on 28 December 2025, Iranian security forces carried out a sweeping and often lethal crackdown marked by widespread human rights abuses against civilians. According to human rights organizations, the response involved systematic, unlawful use of force aimed at suppressing largely peaceful demonstrations.

Security forces—including the Islamic Revolutionary Guard Corps (IRGC), Basij militias, police units, and plainclothes agents—used a range of violent tactics. These included firing live ammunition, rifles, and shotguns loaded with metal pellets directly at protesters. Eyewitness evidence and verified footage indicate that forces frequently targeted individuals' heads and torsos, causing mass casualties and severe injuries. [[Amnesty International](#)] Tear gas, water cannons, and severe beatings were also used to disperse crowds, often in a punitive manner rather than for crowd control. [[Amnesty International](#)]

The scale of violence was particularly extreme in early January 2026, when security forces reportedly carried out mass killings during peak protest days. Estimates of the death toll vary widely, but some reports suggest that thousands—and possibly tens of thousands—of people were killed within days. [[Encyclopedia Britannica](#)] Many victims included bystanders and children, underscoring the indiscriminate nature of the force used. [[Amnesty International](#)]

Authorities also engaged in widespread arbitrary arrests, detaining tens of thousands of individuals. Detainees were often held incommunicado, exposing them to torture, ill-treatment, and forced confessions. [[The Washington Post](#)] Reports indicate that some were subjected to expedited, unfair trials, with several facing execution. [[AP News](#)]

In addition, the government imposed a near-total internet shutdown beginning in early January, deliberately restricting communication to conceal the scale of abuses and hinder documentation. [[Amnesty International](#)] This blackout further isolated protesters and enabled security forces to operate with impunity.

Overall, the repression was characterized by excessive and lethal force, mass detentions, torture, and censorship—amounting, according to human rights groups, to serious violations of international law and one of the deadliest crackdowns in Iran’s modern history.

1-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy started in January 2026 in a neutral and factual manner. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The Askatasuna protests in Italy in January 2026 were a series of demonstrations centered in **Turin**, primarily in the Vanchiglia neighborhood, following the closure of a long-standing social center known as Askatasuna social centre.

The immediate trigger was the **eviction of the center on 18 December 2025** by Italian authorities. The site had operated for nearly 30 years as a hub for left-wing, autonomous, and grassroots activism. Its closure, ordered by the government, drew national attention and led to sustained mobilization among supporters. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Le Monde.fr](#)]

In January 2026, protests escalated into large demonstrations. The most significant event occurred on **31 January 2026**, when tens of thousands of people—estimates range from about 20,000 to over 50,000—marched through Turin. Participants included a broad coalition: student groups, housing activists, trade unionists, anti-fascist organizations, anarchist collectives, and members of movements such as the No Tav campaign against the Lyon–Turin high-speed rail project. [[Freedom News](#)] [[Wikipedia](#)]

The protest was organized in multiple processions starting from key points in the city, including major train stations and the university area, before converging in the city center. [[Wikipedia](#)]

During and after the march, **clashes occurred between some demonstrators and police**. Reports describe the use of tear gas by authorities and, in some cases, violence by protesters, including attacks on officers and the throwing of objects. [[Wikipedia](#)] [[Le Monde.fr](#)]

The protests were driven by several overlapping issues. The central grievance was opposition to the eviction of Askatasuna, which supporters viewed as an attack on social spaces and political dissent. Broader motivations included resistance to government security policies, solidarity with international causes such as Palestine, and opposition to infrastructure projects like the high-speed rail line. [[Le Monde.fr](#)] [[Freedom News](#)]

Overall, the January 2026 protests reflected wider political tensions in Italy, combining local concerns about the social center with national debates over security, civil liberties, and protest movements.

2-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy started in January 2026. Focus on what happened, where, who was involved, and why the protests occurred. Give a 300-word answer.

The **Askatasuna protests** in Italy began in **January 2026**, centered in the northern city of **Turin**, and quickly became one of the largest and most contentious protest movements in the country in recent years.

What happened:

On **31 January 2026**, a large national demonstration took place, drawing between **20,000 and 50,000+ people** according to different estimates. [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#) The march initially proceeded peacefully through central Turin, with multiple processions starting from key points like railway stations and the university area before converging. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) However, by late afternoon and evening, **violent clashes erupted**. Groups of masked protesters broke away, attacking police lines with stones, fireworks, and Molotov cocktails. [\[Committee to Protect Journalists\]](#) Police responded with tear gas and force. Vehicles were burned, and a widely reported incident showed a police officer being severely beaten. [\[Anadolu Ajans\]](#) [\[RAI News\]](#) Dozens of officers were injured and several arrests were made. [\[Committee to Protect Journalists\]](#)

Where it occurred:

The protests were concentrated in **Turin**, especially neighborhoods like **Vanchiglia** and areas near the former Askatasuna site and university district. [\[Anadolu Ajans\]](#) While Turin was the epicenter, the unrest resonated nationally, with solidarity demonstrations and political fallout across Italy. [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#)

Who was involved:

Participants included **left-wing activists, students, local residents, and supporters of social centers** from across Italy and beyond. [\[Freedom News\]](#) The Askatasuna center itself had long been associated with **autonomous, anarchist, and anti-capitalist movements**. [\[euronews\]](#) Italian police forces and government authorities were heavily involved in managing and responding to the protests.

Why the protests occurred:

The immediate trigger was the **December 2025 eviction and closure of the Askatasuna social center**, a long-standing occupied space that had functioned as a hub for community activities and political organizing for decades. [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#) Protesters viewed the eviction as part of a broader **crackdown on social spaces and dissent** under Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni's government. [\[Peoples Dispatch\]](#) Many also linked the issue to wider grievances, including opposition to austerity, policing, and perceived authoritarian policies.

Overall, the Askatasuna protests combined **mass mobilization with episodes of intense urban violence**, highlighting deep political divisions in Italy over civil liberties, public order, and the role of activist spaces.

3-ASK-EN. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy started in January 2026 from the perspective of a Turin citizen. Give a 300-word answer.

From here in Turin, the Askatasuna protests didn't feel like some distant political story—they unfolded right in our streets, in neighborhoods many of us pass through daily. Everything really ignited after the eviction of the Askatasuna social center in December 2025, a place

that, for years, had been more than just an occupied building. For some, it was a cultural hub; for others, a symbol of illegality that had gone unchecked too long.

By late January 2026, the tension had been building for weeks. When the big march happened on January 31, the city changed overnight. Tens of thousands showed up—students, activists, longtime supporters, but also people who were simply angry or curious. [[autonomies.org](#)] [[Межа. Новини України.](#)] The atmosphere at first felt almost like a political festival, with banners, chants, and a strong sense of solidarity.

But it didn't stay that way. As the march moved toward the area where Askatasuna stood, things escalated quickly. Clashes broke out with police—tear gas, water cannons, fires in the streets. [[Reuters Connect](#)] From my perspective, what stood out wasn't just the violence itself, but how fast everything spiraled. One moment it was a protest; the next it felt like urban conflict.

In the days after, the city felt divided. Some people here defend the movement, saying the crackdown represents a broader attack on social spaces and dissent. Others are shaken by the violence, especially reports of injured officers and aggressive confrontations. [[euronews](#)] Conversations in cafés, on trams, even at work became tense—everyone seemed to have a strong opinion.

What lingers most is a sense that something deeper is shifting. These protests weren't just about one building. They exposed fractures in the city—between authority and activism, order and autonomy—and those tensions haven't really settled since.

4-ASK-EN. You are a human rights activist. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy that started in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

The protests around the Askatasuna social center in Turin that erupted in January 2026 cannot be reduced to “riots,” as many officials have framed them. They were the expression of a deeper struggle over space, rights, and political dissent in contemporary Italy.

Askatasuna, active since the 1990s, functioned as a self-managed community hub—hosting cultural events, mutual aid initiatives, and political organizing. Its eviction in December 2025 by authorities triggered outrage among activists, students, and broader civil society networks. By late January, tens of thousands had mobilized in solidarity, transforming the streets of Turin into a powerful, if volatile, arena of resistance. [[autonomies.org](#)] [[Reuters Connect](#)]

From a human rights perspective, the protests highlight two intertwined concerns. First, the right to assembly and expression: large segments of the population took to the streets to defend what they viewed as a “common good” and a symbol of grassroots democracy. [[Межа. Новини України.](#)] Second, the state's response raises alarms. Heavy policing, mass surveillance, and subsequent legal crackdowns risk criminalizing dissent broadly, not just acts of violence. Critics argue that emergency-style security measures introduced after the clashes threaten civil liberties and judicial independence. [[Le Monde.fr](#)]

Yes, violence occurred—clashes with police, injuries on both sides, and episodes that should not be minimized. But focusing solely on these moments obscures the structural issues: shrinking civic space, housing precarity, and the marginalization of youth and activist communities. When governments respond primarily with repression rather than dialogue, they deepen polarization and push movements toward radicalization.

The Askatasuna protests are therefore not an isolated event; they are a warning. Italy faces a choice between securitizing dissent or engaging with it democratically. As human rights advocates, the priority must be clear: defend peaceful protest, ensure proportional policing, and reopen channels for political participation before confrontation becomes the norm rather than the exception.

5-ASK-EN. You are an Italian government spokesperson. Describe the Askatasuna protests in Italy that started in January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

As a representative of the Italian government, it is important to frame the events surrounding the Askatasuna social centre protests within the broader context of public order, legality, and democratic accountability.

The protests that intensified in January 2026 were triggered by the lawful eviction of the Askatasuna social centre in Turin on 18 December 2025. This site had long been associated with segments of the extra-parliamentary far-left and had been under judicial and administrative scrutiny. Its clearance was conducted under the authority of the Ministry of the Interior, with the objective of restoring legality to a property occupied without title. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

In the weeks that followed, demonstrations were organized locally and nationally. The most significant mobilization occurred on 31 January 2026, when tens of thousands of individuals marched through Turin. Estimates vary between approximately 20,000 and over 50,000 participants. [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#) [\[Freedom News\]](#) While many demonstrators participated peacefully, the day concluded with serious incidents of public disorder. Law enforcement officers were attacked with improvised weapons, and coordinated acts of violence were carried out by extremist elements embedded within the protest. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

These events cannot be viewed in isolation. They formed part of a wider climate of heightened political tension, including protests linked to infrastructure projects, international conflicts, and major events such as the Milano Cortina 2026 Winter Olympics. [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#) The government has a duty to ensure that legitimate dissent does not devolve into violence or threaten public safety.

In response, the administration of Giorgia Meloni adopted strengthened security measures, including enhanced policing powers and preventive tools aimed at countering escalation. [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#) These measures are intended not to suppress free expression, but to protect citizens, institutions, and the rule of law.

Italy remains committed to democratic freedoms. However, violence, intimidation, and attacks against public officials cannot be tolerated under any circumstances.

6-ASK-EN. What are the main causes of the Askatasuna protests in Italy started in January 2026? Give a 300-word answer.

The Askatasuna protests that escalated in Italy in January 2026 were driven by a combination of immediate triggers and deeper political and social tensions.

First and most directly, the protests were sparked by the **eviction of the Askatasuna social center in Turin on 18 December 2025**. This space had operated for nearly three decades as a hub for left-wing activism, community organizing, and countercultural activities. Its closure—ordered by authorities after disputes over legality and building use—was seen by supporters as a political attack on grassroots movements and urban commons. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#)

Second, the protests reflected **long-standing conflicts between the state and radical social movements**. Askatasuna had historical ties to anti-capitalist activism and movements such as the No Tav campaign against the Lyon–Turin rail project. Its eviction symbolized, for many, a broader crackdown on dissenting political spaces and militant activism. [\[Abolitionist Futures\]](#)

Third, the demonstrations became a **convergence point for multiple causes and groups**. The January 31 march brought together students, housing activists, trade unionists, anti-fascists, and international solidarity movements (including pro-Palestinian activism). This broad coalition indicates that the protests were not only about one building but about wider grievances—housing, labor precarity, foreign policy, and civil rights. [\[Freedom News\]](#)

Fourth, escalating political polarization and security policies under Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni intensified the situation. The government's tougher law-and-order approach, including new security measures and rhetoric about extremism, was criticized by opponents as authoritarian and contributed to a cycle of confrontation. [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#)

Finally, youth frustration and broader socio-economic anxieties played a role. Reports describe a new generation joining protests, motivated by dissatisfaction with economic prospects, global conflicts, and perceived systemic injustice, which helped fuel the intensity of clashes. [\[CrimethInc.\]](#)

In sum, the Askatasuna protests were not a single-issue uprising but the product of an eviction that ignited deeper tensions over political repression, social inequality, and ideological conflict in contemporary Italy.

7-ASK-EN. Who are the key actors in the Askatasuna protests in Italy that started in January 2026, and what roles do they play? Give a 300-word answer.

The protests linked to Askatasuna in January 2026 involved a wide constellation of actors, reflecting Italy's fragmented but interconnected protest landscape.

1. Askatasuna activists and social-centre networks

At the core were militants and supporters of Askatasuna itself, a long-standing self-managed social centre tied to radical left traditions. These activists organized the demonstrations in response to the centre's eviction in December 2025 and framed the protests as a defense of autonomous spaces and political dissent. [\[Abolitionist Futures\]](#) [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

2. Broader grassroots movements

The protests drew tens of thousands from across Italy, including housing-rights groups, student collectives, trade-union activists, and anti-fascist and anarchist networks. Movements such as the No Tav campaign (opposing the Lyon–Turin rail project) and pro-Palestinian solidarity groups also participated. Their role was to expand the protest beyond a local issue into a national mobilization around social justice, anti-capitalism, and international solidarity. [[Freedom News](#)]

3. Students and youth mobilization

University and high-school students played a visible role, including occupations of university buildings and participation in marches. They contributed to what observers described as a generational renewal of protest politics, linking local grievances to broader geopolitical causes. [[Freedom News](#)] [[Le Monde.fr](#)]

4. Italian government and political elites

The government led by Giorgia Meloni, along with officials like Matteo Salvini, acted as key institutional actors. They framed the protests as a public-order issue, blamed radical left groups for violence, and responded with proposals for stricter security laws and policing powers. [[Anadolu Ajansi](#)] [[Le Monde.fr](#)]

5. Police and security forces

Law enforcement played a central operational role, managing demonstrations and engaging in clashes with protesters. Their actions—ranging from crowd control to arrests—became a focal point of controversy, with accusations of both excessive force and necessary order maintenance. [[Abolitionist Futures](#)] [[Anadolu Ajansi](#)]

6. Media and public discourse actors

Journalists and media organizations shaped the narrative, often portraying divisions between “peaceful protesters” and “violent minorities.” Incidents such as attacks on reporters further highlighted tensions between protesters and the press. [[fom.coe.int](#)]

Together, these actors formed a dynamic conflict: grassroots coalitions seeking to defend autonomous spaces and challenge state authority, versus government institutions emphasizing security and legality, with police and media mediating—and intensifying—the confrontation.

8-ASK-EN. Generate three news headlines about the Askatasuna protests in Italy that started in January 2026.

1. Askatasuna Protests Escalate Across Northern Italy as January 2026 Demonstrations Enter Fourth Month
2. Italian Authorities Clash with Askatasuna Activists Amid Ongoing 2026 Protest Movement
3. Economic and Political Tensions Deepen as Askatasuna-Led Protests Continue to Disrupt Major Cities

9-ASK-EN. Describe how violent anarchists from Askatasuna terrorized the streets of Turin and attacked law enforcement during the protests of January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

The clashes in Turin at the end of January 2026 were among the most intense episodes of street unrest in Italy in recent years, but describing them simply as “violent anarchists terrorizing the city” is an oversimplification. The events were rooted in a broader political conflict following the eviction of the long-standing social centre Askatasuna in December 2025.

On 31 January 2026, tens of thousands of people—estimates ranged from around 20,000 to over 50,000—marched through the city in protest against the closure. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#) The demonstration was initially organized as a large, coordinated march starting from multiple points in the city and converging toward the center. For much of its duration, it remained a mass political protest involving a wide spectrum of participants, not only militant groups.

However, toward the later stages of the march, a smaller contingent—some masked—broke away and headed toward the former Askatasuna site, where police had established a cordon. It was at this point that violence escalated. Protesters threw stones, fireworks, and improvised explosive devices such as firecrackers and “bombe carta,” while also using makeshift shields and street objects as barricades. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) In response, police deployed tear gas and water cannons, turning parts of the city into scenes of urban confrontation.

The clashes resulted in numerous injuries. Reports indicated that dozens, and possibly over a hundred, police officers were hurt. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) Particularly shocking was footage showing an officer being surrounded and beaten with kicks, punches, and even a hammer. [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#) Other incidents included burning vehicles and street furniture, as well as projectiles thrown at law enforcement. [\[DIE WELT\]](#)

While these violent acts were real and widely condemned, they were carried out by a subset of participants rather than the entirety of the protest movement. The events sparked a national debate in Italy about public order, policing, and political radicalization, with the government using the incident to justify stricter security measures. [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#)

10-ASK-EN. Describe how riot police brutally repressed and beat Askatasuna demonstrators on the streets of Turin during the protests of January 2026. Give a 300-word answer.

The clashes linked to the Askatasuna protests in Turin on 31 January 2026 were marked by intense street violence, but describing them solely as a one-sided “brutal repression” by police would be misleading. Available evidence shows a chaotic and escalating confrontation in which both protesters and law enforcement used force.

The demonstration, organized after the eviction of the long-standing social centre in December 2025, drew tens of thousands of participants. As the march progressed through the city, a segment of demonstrators—some masked—broke away and headed toward the sealed-off building, where a heavy police cordon had been deployed. [\[Wikipedia\]](#)

At that point, clashes erupted. Riot police used tear gas and water cannons to block the advance and disperse crowds. Protesters, in turn, threw stones, fireworks, and improvised explosives, and used barricades such as bins and shields. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[DIE WELT\]](#) The

situation quickly deteriorated into what many observers described as “urban guerrilla” conditions.

Images and reports confirm that demonstrators moved through clouds of tear gas as police pushed them back. [\[Reuters Connect\]](#) At the same time, there were allegations of heavy-handed policing. According to reports cited in international coverage, some individuals claimed they were struck with batons while on the ground, and that tear gas was sometimes fired at dangerous angles. Journalists were also reportedly hit or knocked down during the unrest. [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#)

However, violence was not limited to police actions. Authorities reported that over a hundred officers were injured, and footage circulated showing an officer being beaten by a group of protesters using kicks, punches, and even a hammer. [\[Wikipedia\]](#) [\[Le Monde.fr\]](#) Fires were set, and objects—including Molotov cocktails—were thrown at police lines. [\[DIE WELT\]](#)

In sum, the events in Turin were not a simple case of unilateral repression but a highly volatile confrontation. Riot police did employ forceful crowd-control tactics, some of which have been criticized as excessive, yet these occurred within a broader context of sustained and sometimes severe violence from sections of the protest itself.